

PHISHING ATTACK.

HOW TO RECOGNISE, AVOID AND REPORT PHISING

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Learning Objectives

- Define phishing and understand how phishing attacks work.
- Recognize warning signs of **fake or malicious websites**.
- Identify common signs of **fake or malicious websites**.
- Understand social engineering tactics used by attackers.
- Apply best practices to avoid and respond to phishing attacks.

What is Phishing?

Phishing is a cyberattack that uses deception to trick people into revealing sensitive information or performing an unsafe action.

- Attackers often impersonate trusted people or organizations.
- They may target **passwords, OTPs, bank details and personal information.**
- Phishing can happen through **email, SMS, phone calls and fake websites.**
- It relies heavily on human trust and emotions.

 *A message can look legitimate and still be malicious.*

How a Phishing Attack Works

- Attacker creates a fake message or website



- Victim receives the message.



- Attacker creates urgency, fear, curiosity or trust.



- Victim clicks a link, opens an attachment or provide information.



- Attacker steals information or gain access.

Types of Phishing

- Email phishing: fraudulent emails designed to trick victims into clicking links or sharing information.
- Spear phishing: A targeted attack aimed at a specific person or organization.
- Vishing: phishing attack carried out through phone or voice calls SMS or text messages.
- Business Email Compromise: Attackers impersonate executives, employees or business partners to manipulate victims into making payments or revealing information.

How to recognize a phishing Email

- Check the **sender's email address** – not just the display name.
- Beware of **urgent or threatening language** (Act Now).
- Look for spelling and grammar mistakes.
- Don't click suspicious links – verify them first.
- Be cautious with unexpected attachments.
- Never share passwords or OTPs by email.

How to recognize fake websites

- Check the URL/domain name for misspellings.
- Look for extra words or unusual subdomains.
- Be careful if the site asks for passwords or bank details unexpectedly.
- Poor design, broken grammar, and many pop-ups are warning signs.
- HTTPs does not always mean the website is genuine.

✓ Legitimate: www.gtbank.com

⚠ Fake: www:gtbank-login.example

Social Engineering Tactics

Social engineering is the manipulation of people into revealing information or taking unsafe actions.

⚠ Authority: “I’m your manager – send the payment now”.

⚠ Urgency: “Your account will be suspended today”.

- Fear: “your account has been compromised”.
- Curiosity: “see the confidential file attached”
- Reward: “You’ve won a huge amount”.

Real world example

Twitter Attack (2020)

- Attackers used **social engineering** to trick Twitter employees.
- They gained access to internal tools and compromised high-profile accounts.
- Several verified accounts were used to post fraudulent cryptocurrency messages.

Lesson: Even large companies can be compromised when people are manipulated.

Best practices to Avoid Phishing

- Stop and think before clicking unexpected links.
- Verify suspicious requests through a trusted channel.
- Check the sender's email address carefully.
- Inspect links and website URLs before entering information.
- Use strong, unique passwords.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- Avoid opening unexpected attachments.
- Report suspicious emails to your IT/security team.

STOP. THINK. VERIFY. REPORT

What to do if you click a phishing link

- Stop: Don't enter any more information or continue interacting with the page.
- Disconnect: If you suspect malware or unauthorized access, disconnect from the network.
- Report: Notify your IT/security team immediately.
- Change passwords: If you entered your credentials, change the affected password using a trusted device.
- Enable MFA: Add MULTI-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION to the affected account..
- Contact your bank: If financial information was exposed, notify your bank immediately.
- Monitor your accounts: watch for unusual activity.

 STOP. REPORT. CHANGE PASSWORD.

Interactive Quiz 1

You received an email saying: “URGENT your bank account will be suspended today. Click the link below immediately to verify your account”.

What should you do?

- A. Click the link immediately
- B. Reply with your password
- C. Stop and verify the message through trusted channel
- D. Forward it to your friends

Think before you answer.

Quiz 1- Answer

Correct Answer: C

Stop and verify the message through a trusted channel.

Why?

- The message creates urgency and fear.
- It asks you to act immediately.
- You should never use an unexpected link to access your bank account.
- Contact your bank using its official app, website, or known customer-service number.

Remember, Urgency is a common social engineering tactic.

Can you spot a Fake website?

You receive a message directing you to:

<https://gtbank-secure-login.example>

What is the biggest warning sign?

- A. The websites uses HTTPS
- B. The URL contains “secure”
- C. The domain name does not match the bank’s official domain.
- D. The page has the bank’s logo

Think before you click!

Quiz 2 - Answer

Correct Answer: C

The domain name does not match the bank's official domain.

Why?

- Attackers can copy a bank's logo, colors and website design.
- The most important thing to check is the actual domain name.
- Words like "secure", "login", or "official" in a URL do not make it legitimate.
- Never enter your banking credentials until you've verified the website.

Remember: Check the domain, not just the appearance.

Interactive Quiz 3

You receive a phone call from someone claiming to be your bank's security officer. They say your account is at risk and ask you to provide your OTP immediately.

What should you do?

- A. Give them the OTP
- B. Ask them to call back later
- C. End the call and contact your bank through an official channel.
- D. Give them only part of the OTP

What would you do?

Quiz 3 - Answer

Correct answer C

End the call and contact your bank through an official channel.

Why?

- Legitimate bank staff should not ask you to disclose your OTP.
- The caller is using authority, fear and urgency to pressure you.
- Never share your OTP, PIN or password with anyone.

Remember: Your OTP is private. Never share it.

Key takeaways

- Phishing attacks rely on deception and human behaviors.
- Always check sender addresses, links and website domains.
- Be cautious when a message creates urgency, fear or pressure.
- Never share your password, PIN or OTP.
- Verify unusual requests through a trusted channel.
- When in doubt: STOP. THINK. VERIFY. REPORT

Think before you click. Stay alert. Stay secure.

THANK YOU

Phishing Awareness Training Complete.

Stay alert. Think before you click.